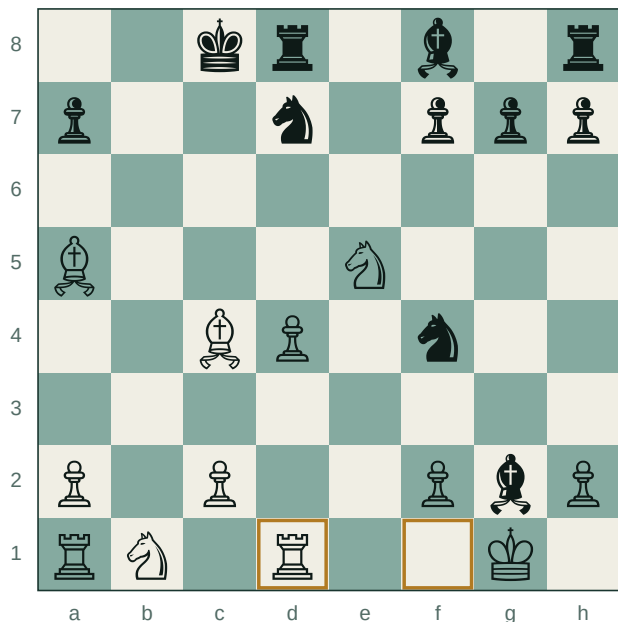


Interference tactics: Black, move 18

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 18.Rd1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18...Nxe5 19. Ba6+ Kb8 20. Nd2 Rxd4

18...Nxe5 The knight captures the knight on e5. Recorded reply: **19.Ba6+**.

19...Kb8 The king moves from c8 to b8. Recorded reply: **20.Nd2**.

20...Rxd4 The rook captures the pawn on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on a5 and rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.